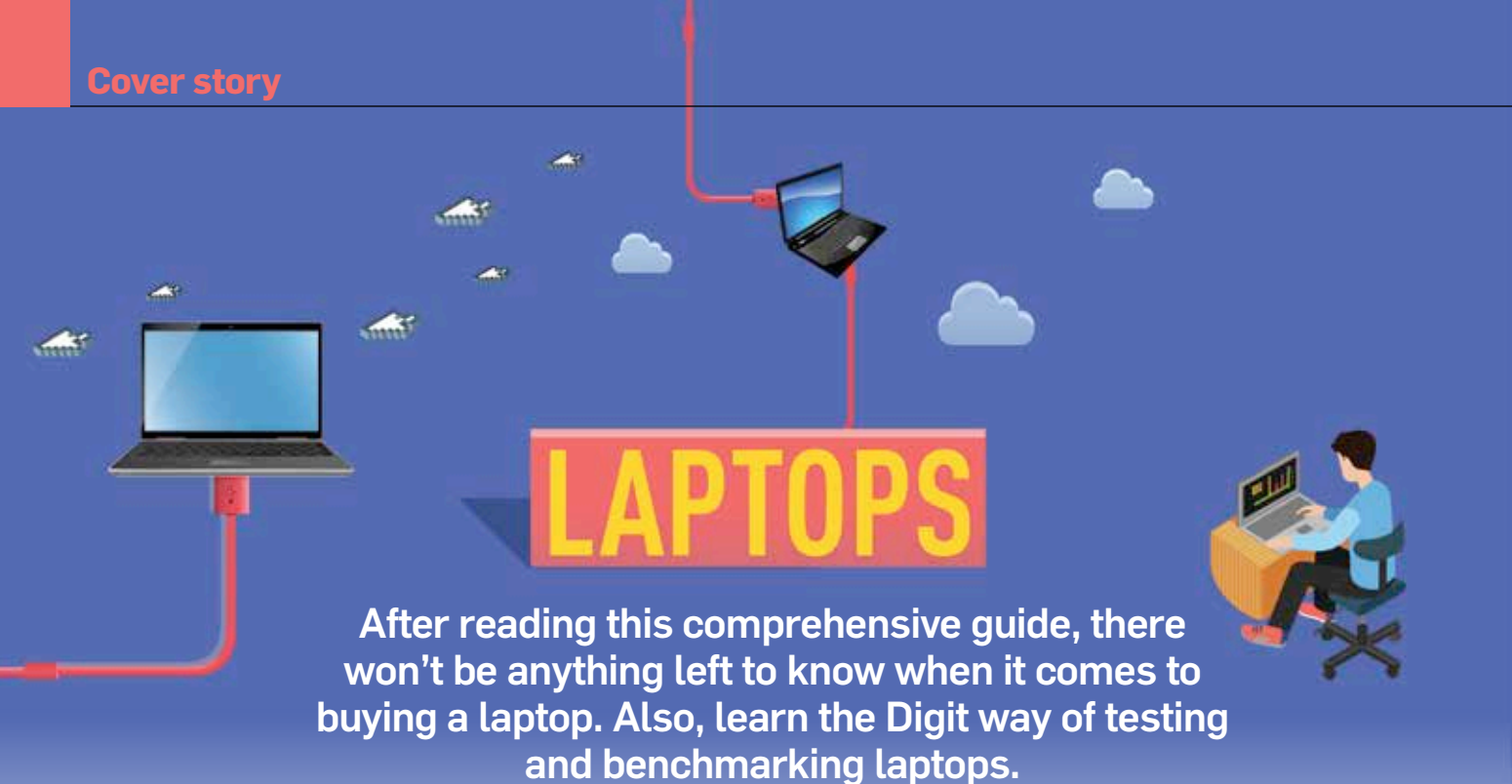




After reading this comprehensive guide, there won't be anything left to know when it comes to buying a laptop. Also, learn the Digit way of testing and benchmarking laptops.

By **Jayesh Shinde**

In the world of computing, laptops are the new desktops, at least when it comes to purchasing decisions driving people to buy their very first computer.

No one wants a boring old box sitting on their desk anymore, people prefer laptops over the world due to their portability. And there are so many laptop types available in the market right now – Ultrabooks, Chromebooks, Netbooks, Hybrid Laptops, Gaming Laptops and more. It's a great time to be a prospective laptop owner!

With so many different laptop models and endless hardware configurations to choose from, how do you single out the one laptop that's worthy of purchase? Whether you're a cash-strapped consumer shopping for a notebook PC on a tight budget or an entertainment junkie looking to replace his aging desktop with a powerful all-purpose laptop. In the next couple of pages, we outline some ground rules to remember and abide by when you're researching your next laptop. Not only that, we also outline a quick hands-on test you can perform on any laptop in an electronics store before concluding if it's your money's worth at all. And lastly, we complete this buying guide by empowering you with tools and techniques that let you effectively benchmark and diagnose your laptop's com-

ponents – most of which Digit uses right here in our Test Center while testing and reviewing laptops.

Processor

This is the heart and soul of your PC, an important cog to consider. AMD or Intel is an age old question that's still a matter of serious debate among enthusiasts the world over. While things may not be plain and simple in the PC world, in the laptop world the advantages and disadvantages are clear as day.

Before we sort that out though, bear in mind that this is the single most impor-

tant component in your laptop. Laptops aren't traditionally meant to be power-houses, but a good CPU goes a long way in ensuring a more comfortable computing experience, and in future-proofing your device.

Intel: For a bare-bones laptop, anything above Intel's Celeron 1000 series of CPUs (i.e., any CPU launched since 2013) should suffice. From every test we've conducted, one thing's blindingly obvious – if you're going for a laptop, get one that's powered by Intel's Haswell CPUs (basically Intel CPUs with a model number that goes 4xxx). The improve-

